COURSE · MODULE 04

Module 04 · Lifecycle, gates and funnel

How a use case moves forward, what a gate can decide and why the portfolio is managed like a sales funnel

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25	8	5	2
minutes	phases, from 0 to 7	possible outcomes of a gate	iterations before the decision is escalated

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01

Objective

By the end you will be able to say which phase a use case is in, what it is asked for to pass its gate, what the competent body can decide and how the portfolio is read in the use case register.

02

Key ideas

1. **Eight phases and a gate at the end of each.** In phase 6 (operation) the gate is a periodic continuity review, R6.
2. **Dual validation.** A gate checks both the result and the documentation. Without verified evidence there is no decision.
3. **Five outcomes**: proceed, proceed with conditions, iterate, pivot or stop. At G7: scale, iterate or retire. **Stopping is a good outcome** when it avoids building something unfeasible; G3 is the main stop gate.

4. **The portfolio is a funnel.** As in sales, stages, times, requirements and loss reasons are recorded. Unlike sales, the aim is not to convert more, but to decide well.

03

Guided tour

Step	What to open	What to look at
1	document 01, section 6.1	The table of phases with the question each one answers.
2	document 01, section 7	How a gate works, the outcomes and who verifies and decides.
3	document 21, section 6.4	The G3 criteria: code, evidence, obligation and Lite or Enterprise column.
4	document 04, section 4	What is taken from sales funnel management and where the framework departs from it.
5	document 03, sections 3.5 and 3.6	Funnel metrics and reference time limits per phase.
6	T01, funnel, board and gates views	The example portfolio by phase, time in phase and the status of each criterion.

04

Exercise

In the example register (T01):

1. Click a bar of the funnel to filter the use cases in that phase. Which one has been in its phase the longest?
2. Open IA-2025-004 (screening of job applications). At which gate was it stopped, for what reason and what was learnt?
3. Open IA-2025-005. It was not stopped: it was retired after being in use. Why?
4. Open the example board dashboard (T17) and find those two cases in the funnel exit cards.

05

Self-check

1. What two things does dual validation check?
2. What happens if a use case iterates twice at the same gate?
3. Can "proceed with conditions" be approved on a security criterion marked "Yes ◆"?
4. Is a 100% conversion at every gate a good sign?

06

Next step

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Answers. 1) The result (what the data or tests demonstrate) and the documentation (that the evidence exists, is valid and is verified). 2) The third decision is taken by the higher body. 3) No: those criteria are never accepted as a condition. 4) No: it points to soft gates or to a portfolio that only admits safe bets.